

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Tesla approved a stock award** for Elon Musk of \$23.7 billion in what it described as a “first step” to keep him engaged with the business for at least two years. **A1, B1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** rallied, notching their largest daily percentage gain since May, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow rising 1.5%, 2% and 1.3%, respectively. **B1**
- ◆ **Foxconn plans to work** with partners to convert a former electric-truck factory in Lordsburg, Ohio, into a plant making cloud-computing hardware for AI applications. **A2**
- ◆ **Quantitative funds lost** 9.6% in the first half of this year, failing to deliver the returns that such trend followers are expected to produce in volatile markets. **B1**
- ◆ **Harley-Davidson** appointed Artie Starrs, head of sports-entertainment company Topgolf, to be its new president and chief executive officer. **B1**
- ◆ **The New York Post** Media Group plans to launch a new, Los Angeles-based venture early next year under the title The California Post to be edited by Nick Papps. **B2**
- ◆ **Tyson's operating profit** from its chicken business rose to \$367 million in the quarter ended in June, vindicating the meatpacker's years-long turnaround effort. **B3**
- ◆ **Online furniture retailer Wayfair** swung to an unexpected profit in the second quarter as revenue rose despite a drop in active users. **B3**
- ◆ **Spotify said** premium subscribers in markets across a number of regions would see the price of their membership increase. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Trump's high-stakes push** to create more Republican House seats and keep the majority from flipping to Democrats erupted into a cross-country fight. **A1**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** tapped a grand jury to reinvestigate the intelligence community's assessment of Russia's efforts in the 2016 election, escalating a long-standing Trump grievance. **A4**
- ◆ **More Israelis** are calling for an end to the war in Gaza while decrying the dire humanitarian situation in the enclave, marking a shift in the public discourse. **A1**
- ◆ **Israel's government** voted to fire the country's attorney general, who is also overseeing Prime Minister Netanyahu's corruption trial, as part of an overhaul of the judiciary. **A7**
- ◆ **The White House** is drafting an executive order that would step up pressure against big banks over perceived discrimination against conservatives and crypto companies. **A4**
- ◆ **Fake studies** are flooding legitimate scientific journals and are proliferating faster than current checks can identify and purge them. **A3**
- ◆ **Defense Secretary** Hegseth's missteps have spurred infighting at the Pentagon and raised concerns among some Republicans in Congress about his ability to run the department. **A5**
- ◆ **Brazil's Supreme Court** ordered former Brazilian President Jair Bolsonaro be put under house arrest, as the justices weigh evidence that he plotted a military takeover in 2022. **A7**

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Thousands of Israeli protesters marched through Habima Square in Tel Aviv last week to oppose the war in Gaza.

More Israelis Question Morality Of Continued War in Gaza Strip

Protests, criticism of Netanyahu policy grow along with the humanitarian crisis

By ANAT PELED

TEL AVIV—Dor Eilon held up a poster of an emaciated Gazan child for the first time at an antiwar protest last week. The 29-year-old lawyer had joined dozens of other Israelis as they stood silently in the summer heat at a square in Tel Aviv with the photos in hand. “It’s not moral to ignore this,” said Eilon, who began attending protests to free the

hostages several months ago, but now says she feels a duty to highlight the plight of Gazans. “Usually I hand out stickers and people smile at me. And here people look away from me.”

In recent weeks, more Israelis—including prominent public figures—have called to end the war in Gaza while decrying the dire humanitarian situation in the enclave, marking a shift in the public discourse. A majority of former directors of the Israeli military, intelligence agency, internal security agency and the police called on the Israeli government on Sunday to end the war against Hamas. The

cause began as a just one after the Oct. 7, 2023, attacks, they said. But now it has become futile.

While polls in Israel have shown for months that a large majority of Israelis, including on the right, want to end the war in exchange for the hostages, dire conditions in the enclave and the worsening food crisis are spurring more dissent on moral grounds and leaving Israel more internationally isolated than ever.

Nightly news reports have featured more Gazans talking about suffering in the strip. Photos of Gazans killed in the war are now more visible in some public spaces such as

protests. More than 1,000 leading Israeli artists created a stir when they signed a petition calling to end the killing of children and civilians in Gaza. A large proportion of those who have been killed during the war, 60,000 in all, have been minors, according to Gaza health authorities who don’t say how many are combatants.

Heads of the country’s major universities demanded Israeli authorities do more to help adequate food supplies enter the strip. Israel’s most famous living novelist, David

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◆ **Israeli government ousts attorney general.....** A7

Tesla Dangles Payout to Keep Musk Engaged

The tech executive could get a package valued at \$23.7 billion if he stays for 2 years

By THEO FRANCIS

Tesla took a “first step” to keep its leader Elon Musk focused on the struggling electric-vehicle maker, awarding the world’s richest man one of the biggest-ever stock awards to stick around for at least two years.

Tesla’s board approved a stock award for Musk that it tentatively valued at \$23.7 billion, which he can claim in two years unless a court rescues his prior, larger stock-option grant. Musk has run Tesla without a pay package since his \$50 billion option award was tossed by a court in 2024.

The electric-vehicle maker said its “interim award” of 96 million shares will vest as long as Musk remains on the job as chief executive or under another executive title heading product development or operations, according to a securities filing. It described the award as a “first step, good faith payment” to keep him engaged.

Tesla’s business has been in a funk this year amid falling vehicle sales as investors fret about how much time Musk is spending on other pursuits. After stepping back from his work as a White House adviser in late May, he has overseen the launch of Tesla’s robotaxi service. But he also has been rounding up billions in funding for unprofitable xAI while SpaceX overcame a

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◆ **A few CEOs earn billions of dollars in raises.....** B1

Strains Inside BLS Made It Vulnerable

By MATT GROSSMAN

President Trump’s decision to fire the head of the Bureau of Labor Statistics on Friday ignited a crisis at the U.S.’s top economic-stats agency. But it wasn’t the start of the BLS’s challenges.

In the past few years, the BLS has faced tighter budgets and falling response rates to its surveys. In recent months, it has faced staff shortages brought on by a hiring freeze Trump declared in January.

Those internal pressures made the agency more vulnerable to attack from the president, who seized on routine statistical revisions to claim that the bureau is stacking the numbers against him for political reasons.

Trump and other White

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◆ **Heard on the Street: Firing imperils confidence.....** B10

INSIDE



U.S. NEWS
Navy ships, subs languish in repair yards as U.S. struggles to maintain its fleet. **A5**



JASON GAY
The Savannah Bananas are reinventing baseball in appealing fashion. **A12**

Texas Gambit Spurs Battle to Tilt Maps

President Trump’s high-stakes push to create more Republican House seats and keep the majority from flipping to Democrats has erupted into a

By Olivia Beavers, Meridith McGraw and John McCormick

cross-country fight, prompting the exodus of Democratic state lawmakers from Texas and leading blue-state governors to hatch their own plans.

Both parties are now racing to remake congressional lines in a slew of mid-decade redistrictings, breaking with traditional once-a-decade changes and injecting further uncertainty into what is expected to be a down-to-the-wire fight for House control next year.

Texas is at the center of GOP gerrymander efforts after Trump successfully lobbied Republican Gov. Greg Abbott to call a special session to redraw

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‘Private-Jet Money’ Is New Wealth Yardstick

By GUNJAN BANERJI

When Maxx Chewning sold his sour-candy business to Hershey for \$75.5 million, the first thing he did—before buying a Rolex or dream home—was jet his wife and six friends to Vail on a Dassault Falcon 900.

They skipped security lines, zipped straight to the runway and seated themselves in

leather recliners with gold accents in the wood-paneled cabin. The price tag for this adventure: \$100,000.

Chewning’s goldendoodle, Dood, sprawled at their feet. “The joke is, I had to get a private plane so I could bring my dog,” the 35-year-old said. “I didn’t really care what the price was.”

The ultrawealthy have always enjoyed flying private.

That exclusive club is growing, as soaring stocks and crypto prices mint more millionaires and billionaires, who now have a range of choices to book a seat on a jet.

Flying private has become the ultimate luxury splurge for many wealthy individuals, surpassing Ferraris, Hermès Birkin bags topping \$14,000 or even waterfront Hampton homes. For many of those as-

piring to join the ranks of the truly rich, having “private-jet money” is the new goal, dividing the 1% from the 0.1%.

The pandemic unleashed a burst of demand, but providers say popular culture has turbocharged enthusiasm and envy for the fly-private lifestyle. Social media has given younger people a glimpse into the lives of jet-setters,

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The Vanishing Bear That Still Draws a Crowd to Canada

This elusive resident of British Columbia’s rainforest is ‘too cool to be real’

By ANGELA OWENS

GREAT BEAR RAINFOREST, British Columbia—Every year, nature lovers from around the world come to see a ghostly creature that prowls the cloud-shrouded forests of the islands off Canada’s Pacific

Coast.

The so-called spirit bears are black bears with a rare genetic mutation that gives them a creamy white coat. The creatures, unique to British Columbia, appear on posters and souvenirs throughout

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AI Revolution Tangles Up Disney

Studio caught between technology, protecting its characters

By JESSICA TOONKEL AND ERICH SCHWARTZEL

When Disney began working on a new, live-action version of its hit cartoon “Moana,” executives started to ponder whether they should clone its star, Dwayne Johnson.

The actor was reprising his role in the movie as Maui, a barrel-chested demigod, but for certain days on set, Disney had a plan in place that wouldn’t require Johnson to be there at all.

Under the plan they devised, Johnson’s similarly buff cousin Tanoai Reed—who is 6-foot-3 and 250 pounds—would fill in as a body double for a small number of shots. Disney would work with AI company Meta-physic to create deepfakes of Johnson’s face that could be layered on top of Reed’s performance in the footage—a “digital double” that effectively allowed Johnson to be in two places at once.

What happened next was evidence that

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